

Lee was a perfect companion for Ilgner and his Circle. He, too, said Ilgner, was interested in all parts of the world. He had intended to visit Belgium and Italy anyway. "And Schmitz, who had been in the United States all this time, arrived on the same steamship with Ivy Lee in Europe." In Lee's pocket was a contract hiring him "to do what he could to combat the renewed press attacks in the United States against National Socialism and at the same time...I.G." "I.G.," added Ilgner: "The greatest enterprise with large American interests was particularly interested in a favorable American press on German economies in general."

That Spring, Lee went first to Rome to visit Mussolini. From there he went to France and Belgium. Then he came to Berlin to see Ilgner, Bosch and Schmitz, as arranged. Lee wanted to see Hitler immediately. The Circle of Economics Advisors being in Goebbels's disfavor, Ilgner arranged for Lee to see Hitler through the Carl Schurz Association, of which Ilgner was President. Lee talked to Hitler at length, after which he wanted to meet the other top Nazi leaders. Ilgner took him to see Goebbels, vice Chancellor von Papen, Foreign Minister von Neurath and the Economics Minister Schacht.

According to Ilgner, Ivy Lee protested against the German boycott of Jewish goods and advised Hitler to remove it. "When Lee had sufficiently informed himself, I took ~~him~~ upon myself the practical application of ^{his} ~~Mr. Lee's~~ suggestions."

To accomplish what Lee advised, Ilgner called upon the Carl Schurz Association, ^{this} which according to its by-laws was an "organization of Good Will, to promote friendship between